POST

The Hill Article: "Covid-19 will accelerate AI's replacement of humans as factor of production

April 14, 2020

Ceres AI ramping up as demand for automation, virtual, remote, and digitial environmental management increases

Ceres AI spending 33% more … “ramping up” development as demand for environmental artificial intelligence, automation, virtual, remote, and digital workflow increases in the wake of Covid-19.

As the world speeds toward an unprecedented economic recession (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlUew8Tn6m-lVqUJWHvTJ3mZaFmhHbkbOhe3Me3WxjwuouxTIVSEy_FEmVc9IpZE0pMn1F8LlAMC_DJeMbK9EHafwRH0qtjNitLc2kRQXOvS5MxWazOUP06Q==&c=&ch=) with billions of people and businesses across the planet under some form of lockdown—for weeks or months—amid one of the worst pandemics on record, counting (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5Plfkouw8IDM9PCmWGJ80-NE6d5FYoEpjzPpsPjtylA8FWhdBSRQGB5PZ3ZVKbxjdDVJEEiVclvxCBocMIdMb8zGuSi6PoKkfwm&c=&ch=) more than 1.8 million people infected and more than 100,000 dead so far, the novel coronavirus will likely produce a yet more enduring change in a post-COVID-19 world: the replacement of humans as factor of production.

Prior to COVID-19, the often-contested race between human productivity options and machine productivity advantages appeared less definite. In the last two decades and with aim of making humans highly productive, promoting general wellbeing and increasing business competitiveness, several ideas gained traction—namely, telecommuting (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlS4B59yZptU4DLNXS_tyFSEeNOlbeoJW_p_Vj8UBaPWNi9QhmfjofpoD-pz3szTjMaG12hrEK0JAiYRsKdrG5y2XeprgWQXztO1bH26fBBzK5qjZ6N1eNNtzLQ-KjRgdUn3oqAxK2S4f7Lp-rjKA3oehpnBBsLGAX&c=&ch=), remote work (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlbypzpQi9Itf0x35AlhaCawRpuwuDdX75YnHnnOrNFJjt9vHCJywqtc9bLfQR-0YVRxY7Yd-GSGoBwLZqV_cfBBGTRpcZi33tIWbq7XKwtbYAGYM4NKr1uJv7_T55jmnZg-rYZUV07RGJW7TgRgdE9A==&c=&ch=), and coworking spaces (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlQ0e12E12_Kzu2bihTmd18yaXheZ6t3VOAmS-Tlp42pSt00aBMlIibBX9wEqGd8vXFF4sfxteC37849oX9WcHEQMztFRqTdWzuOXfxx3n_k3gg9ysgxlEOD-YxnqtmnNOKHzyL9cpuzxBKkZ86-Subw==&c=&ch=). In fact, billions of dollars have been invested (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlyW41ueLFTafmE-A2bOkCzR7Z0eIf2xPnvMQVS1SLewnupM54p6GuQUpF-GOj_z7nxSktO-OSulbd2zwSYefToVZWbESHaDjnbe09pRkR_GAIXY8VqRknsA==&c=&ch=) around the world in real estate ("co-working spaces") to enable people to commute to their workplace by either just taking an elevator or walking a few blocks from home. Yet the very nature of the COVID-19 virus imposing social distancing as precautionary measure has made remote work our last available option to move on with our lives.

Prior to COVID-19, moreover, investment in artificial intelligence (AI) was already on the rise, going from $12 billion in 2017 (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5Pl4Ky4yNosKnO82onW471DRMf9KEzpdiZa5C82CEaGuE4HCkGL3iHwoOrJO90--UFlgrmUkW6rTuL9Q4fa6XqOvGJE52jPWNsnL

AhEN3a_qCDXaHFuGK7v6QIKBdTIcU-8L5kOTru_VnaDVYS092U8kGy_xpO5bipLaYPS0PBHoOueIsDV5UrX05TfYwiPctVx&c=&ch=) to projected $60 billion in 2021 (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5Pl4Ky4yNosKnO82onW471DRMf9KEzpdiZa5C82CEaGuE4HCkGL3iHwoOrJO90--UFlgrmUkW6rTuL9Q4fa6XqOvGJE52jPWNsnLAhEN3a_qCDXaHFuGK7v6QIKBdTIcU-8L5kOTru_VnaDVYS092U8kGy_xpO5bipLaYPS0PBHoOueIsDV5UrX05TfYwiPctVx&c=&ch=). These figures don't count private (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlaApgsVRHTnqktKuvP1Fc_4x3mmm4KZ_4hbdaK2tEsmJUS0yZFoucKrKxSyK__jlXH8zqRRfOFVmqy9JCEz-Sgn3Upv6t4oezUHpWdNprOhvBViMVy3hyJpAJ9cNS1qa0v-EBlHHNXEQ45gX548w9vv1ZRIdmP39wd6jk2qrHd4XD3slano_lOnwzLs7gYj3ZP3atZQXU6QR8OIvk51Dqtg==&c=&ch=) investments in the more controversial intelligence enhancement (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlxsYK1LsbviaYLjZ-P5uC5dgoDJLi5HPgEQ8K3DNqiob-GvKeAUUhp9kqJh7-UIA_bxVI6S0vHZovYeparunZUx-ltBgQynH8-N_SyYbUmBc=&c=&ch=)(IE). Instead, this trend reflects massive investments in current artificial intelligence (machine and deep learning) and, gradually, major investments in future AI—quantum artificial intelligence (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlP28_tRgksn3O8F0QpU4WQ-Of8r7JkyuI31NF6tVT1aUphrReDdEBQl1i047-ORdZ1IAM6rDRFrZNJSb6ZFwARbN1XKhdf54mvhb_xBBO_DT5nDvnUJ53kjJVGvNZbT9X&c=&ch=) (QAI) and quantum computing technology in United States (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMpK71LReV9U_T_Xq_gX4lPkc2PEN6tCDbYW9-Z-L7St8CYuKRYLKfTntJCh2yi_jeWF7qQO8MeahrubbLp6pbRxYEHGa-xSmovYYQ2d_wNMsjYWY5RPuOwhz8kMkB7R36Oig8YI_C8U88Q4fS2oltbA-LJOxmHmN_ytEQLFFPe_aPTqJenKTJKuB4VRKodaAxg==&c=&ch=), China (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlL_isIKbE1cbm9TLP2mFpGQ4VBHZqaxrYQ05M_FGKYMOYJz7IRVw9FM_UQt8LfB4GEDypcFtLyxNcjKZrGRSKG3u2H2KAT2Sy49qPZwNY7BdSApdurT4uySJAhmJEgvugHfQ6brklqIe7VgUlKNUKKy89xqkRhyZQOhG1bi8VKLFQX5xSthpRx3QeTQU_2-A1&c=&ch=), Canada (ht

tp://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlJoyqU0HZXNKOX_eRqzFdf_sKglCuh3K6qJDfDJ1Rs5_ym4FZ3YS1tABU344PG6ejft3RMvyTtiYxXYp769w_h2gZjkn5fCiH0qWm3r9Hm6q3PGkpV3EZsbRchDmm-I8vM4D6y5_Ezua2RRXN0JgRUA==&c=&ch=), Japan (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlL7V_Q1feEbBiR4dZTULSk_kE46j94htNxfxcawm3pQUz_afQ18j_oHZX470-jUEuxid7tGgKHxD-e00LlZ0WA_qpeFmO5q5sAesXViEiMLp0-ktkGiREkm9Q9cKwuWzCcQ7i1sjrUFSCR5N2zSLaE64VKD7T9cuOuyyKhsJ8b2Ufa7t99hmKFrMkQe-v41sw&c=&ch=),India (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlL_NXC8SdePtPSDtOrRoYuT0sH6eokxL-p7gACt1TS8CgsX-wang4iw_fvPW6S-nC-lSlMxtFPuL99daIwq0JktLMq2Keg3UEO9f3mU3Ogq-XQIq7hBPS0lJY7CRpeXgYrzxrWi3eBxjt9JQqv-Y-dWNE5OIcLL4-NXKu4qmL-FXpXQdFjY6r3A==&c=&ch=), Germany (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlGRviEaJsQG-K1r6Y4rOJAK4rGvFINXjq8aqFww74PILhT1Y74jWPkOSzIFZpLauxRFUihxwqtnXX4jWhz20b5ioTmVBSI9lKUuhVG77EjBUQniohuydyctQG1X1Nl38auMOSuw0p_QyY7m2V2IC3n74mjRVxpGpfQLoPQk62UVpSER9SgtdxAxJill9SvUNnhq0aUmGNkXMCDb_3hCXPw0tgE4Z8R3CM&c=&ch=) and Russia (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlSPYuMOxWGvMGHSx_Wb_EWD0cfd8jsWnodeSVyYK-p4jBeX2psV8Rv4-Oy44sOEnN6Y8mdyndaX2tf6Qp9HCFcfKgH1ZLFbqvGbn8FKpQW6fr6JN_4ePGFUqM7e7eyOymPA9v7BxEIq0=&c=&ch=).

Make no mistake, as companies are losing billions of dollars across the globe, COVID-19 will be the triggering event leading to the acceleration of AI's replacement of humans as factor of production.

Most governments, international organizations, companies, and universities have now transitioned to remote work. And by now, people interacting within these organizations have learned about the restrictions and, quite likely, the psychological effects such limited interaction produces. In fact, notwithstanding direct benefits (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMj

ompmbGi5PlvZyvTrjFC6l4vkCfqGp5FKg3hqH-Za2Bw2Af2ETL6U5Cr7GQnHN0GPILU3910xTJA WF0pVdSEwZxrHhfuCABxLpXec6DXvr6UNTOHxNAQsElrAcFz766kzQmqLNWeYcqtPFDBLuGB _vqclABHJiueHk0aYkc12ctWBWSdCFOfLwHHldzE-szszpc34eEiiCVqKk6YRrEILjMRxrFx54Qh2 RH8xD1C-z0&c=&ch=) (less commuting time, stress reduction, creativity boost) and incidental advantages (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju 5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5Pl3hFr3qnAOr0PVJO2NR5ZXyQu-dNdkduh7Q0jqUwTD E0M2GP100J9m2RhUl7dcDprcpxRysruunPduJm53MGC8OHj6_RKHN4JciBtM6S8Q00PbqYHqy jZrCC-RiP-yLt3MBs2LiZSHPyXz00BPQpoMk8szAu_NRJB&c=&ch=) found in remote work (reduction of environmental, operative, healthcare, and liability costs) research on the psychological impact (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96j Oju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlmgehExMm9NQ_y9Q6cPAi93R34T5MglVTFxtvW VmDGdL4MD2MZTflDYfUhTmEINw9ZMjB-DZeV2J0VbmWw7KXdWdaiDb_oroDPYUbVgjuprqc XWm-AeSJMdzvlzAPmkfR&c=&ch=) of remote work indicates that isolation (http://r20.rs 6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi 5Pl1snjhND1UkpFq4ZIcMv6mZOj0q2tj3Sm4qY9TcWJLKnaTQbpWz4K2bw6zwCQVTLAUveI_60 R4TGMrWnhL7NradxnqF9yq3tYQ1yvG3-dVcLtdwd6XYG6fDW4IACNnn-d&c=&ch=), depression (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnK JcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5Pluh68cGoAxN94jNj8A0R44g8y61zs-NuVLxBvHgD5R9T_RLJ3cm1T iFIs9L_hCrmhIgEymmnSLALDO7fBemdL2S40WFr0pMsgKhqdTkINK1l_ldIwNY2rhDXqOZOanr SQW0EOrDm64zWyXkVjxtcdFzgHbmma50Mu6TJTa9KjWcnQpHXw0fm2vQiC93_h13Ru&c=&ch =), passive leadership (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju 5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlfR_VFlotgPUEs-uCQDnf6P4mmzuuhQXErT_z-njWxFz m3D0FhTNw2Vytmyjh8S6J-nBfeKQciBZNBPTJ-Q33lhtTFLZjRuK4ArHRPfZPuPKbo2i9QLKYvQ 2y2S00ttNRLhZifxwAY8rVML7MU7OY0R-SJ_hOUgmOcnHnxWqSZhI=&c=&ch=), and lack of communication (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrd XhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5Plv78RMsZf7NL3KfONpCP-rlFaPPPSI5z5Ipl5_6rL5zQDwlRzc

QJz7DkjtWiv_xpxooA3Th5R9AIzboHoCZoMkHGFHWcWOf_NZRjte740HUM85gc6VFtOzTAer_USC3n1eWbY4pdFZj8sdmgAYeQA5FVi6ht2RMtaPAIWBQR95hoaMOhKn2KExfpUXBrpY___&c=&ch=) (decreasing teamwork efforts) are some of the most consequential effects.

Despite existential, human rights, and socioeconomic concerns (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlIXC-J9ZncvBJWWTDx8RCjmr3j975k5mrIaJrlKvUIilkCwGQb1JfkhQMOoQVtHLJkEB2vTr14SkIXHrPY1G_PeWaqRV7APEv4d75lpHLo2vlwjfv10qHFjh8CyPsO8w4o3dtjW5Sy7tZSGbznur5XYZSsYNzxCQmSKKv47szmoBT-sTgtLXeBg-IrqKW2YV5YBwkIWZOqGA=&c=&ch=) about automation, the premise promoting an automated world is rather simple and, in many ways, unavoidable. That is, unlike humans, machines do not get sick and, thus, will not stop production—particularly when this one is needed the most. In the midst of a pandemic and in a fully automated world, machines could provide humans with a much-needed uninterrupted chain of food supply and healthcare-critical equipment (tests, ventilators, masks, gloves, hospital beds)—as well as automated (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5Plt--RwV0Np-Ds1OiF0wXQ5N-kQYJjeQlEYchttL41XE2vTBVzVshmj9Vx3ENJg0ydvK8KTo-WloUjPDdXZel7KRUwH5C8BTNgl3Au_iwtj7GqPPMjEG5C8uRFrERzYNptrE5p_KjVLhktvJkhRrQamw==&c=&ch=) and remotely supervised (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5Plv1sADWxKWDSKqzxZ6rddWhVksJkoKQmthPr4SjVAMv5iFqyTert_4GS-T7zznIyuyesP_yGwRYoB7PMx5uq8cmDryTfjH87zSTAgR-z2-WNkD1vLU-bcQFwXXQ2y8lia8bSBBZppm2qhzNmxlzg8VqXZMhnA-Ki_PBBGXUpNx2ByaN4QZmo-SOrYG1Tv7BBF&c=&ch=) medical attention with minimal or no risk of infection to medical workers. The benefits—both in human lives saved and in uninterrupted economic activity—are, at least in the short term, indisputable.

Still, the effects of this replacement in the long term and in relation to human interaction, functionality, and purpose are far more complex. What would we do with the millions of humans who will not transition (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3n

HEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMjompmbGi5PlrYPAioVW8G00s1lxflo5Fs31EV1eIh50Nnp0yIX_7mvHf7lt8knZ7w4AehzuHspyJnsbiHNwIOMnOTHHSFkRhddBNTPxrmdDAaejx1qYHgdnWUBRzHcJ6bYWou_Je4ataP7YO7iKkPs0e1Mrm6hHWwekykr216cBtdFDeBLpu6R9f-mEJkHKsEiViVHFVX2Iv42zknZXbeLaXipghrQ9Nt9Ghurh_otR&c=&ch=) towards other creative, highly-specialized, or managerial tasks? How could a fully automated world assure continued consumption, human dignity and sources of revenue to all its inhabitants—as well as socioeconomic equality among people and countries? Unfortunately, these concerns are unlikely to be at the forefront of the upcoming-accelerated automation process. After all, the decision-making process of modern humans, their political systems, and their leaders are not characterized by their long-term perspective.

In the post-COVID-19 world, the numbers reflecting the pandemic and its economic impact will likely become the justification for a shift of paradigm in human production.

Making determinations about our future during the most uncertain present will thus require not merely competence but wisdom. Return to normalcy is a self-deception.

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More Information on Ceres AI (http://r20.rs6.net/tn.jsp?f=001iF3nHEL_7BJGlKGzDrYS-2E2Ft96jOju5RFrdXhnKJcZQUgJMQjqMmZCpynyoLkb5tMQIF0wn6flJBlN4gpB4u0Ft3G14rYWHi2BOfYN1pfpIBGKohb5Mv4-YEAofjeNpJp3NnXUa48G6xEK4xYyFg==&c=&ch=)

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